

Furman University Jazz Ensemble Constitution

Article I. Purpose

The Furman University Jazz Ensemble is an organization that exists to provide opportunities for students to pursue jazz performance. Jazz is a uniquely American art form and has enjoyed worldwide popularity for over a century. The jazz ensemble and combos perform concerts both on and off campus for a wide variety of events, including those that serve the music department, the Furman campus, the Upstate community, and the music community at large. We also bring world-class guest artists to campus to inspire the Furman community.

Article II. Membership

- A. Membership in the Furman University Jazz Ensemble and/or Combos is open to any Furman student.
- B. Membership is by audition only. Auditions occur at the beginning of each fall term. Students who are selected to be a member of a jazz group are expected to remain a member for the entire academic year.
- C. Students must register for the appropriate ensemble (zero hours credit) in order to be a member.

Article III. Materials

Members are expected to own their own instrument and appropriate accessories (mutes, mouthpieces, cords, etc.). In some cases, students may use select University-owned equipment, which is to be signed out from the Furman Band Department.

Article IV. Attendance and Discipline

Membership is dependent upon consistent attendance at, and preparation for, all rehearsals and performances. In the case of an excused absence for a rehearsal, the member will secure the services of a capable substitute and receive permission from the director at least 24 hours prior to the rehearsal. In the case of a personal scheduling conflict with a performance, the member will secure permission from the Director of Jazz Studies three weeks in advance of the conflict. Members will receive one unexcused absence from a rehearsal each term. Any additional unexcused absences of any kind will result in an unsatisfactory grade for the term and possible dismissal from the ensemble.

Article V. Leadership

- A. The Director of Jazz Studies' duties shall include:
 - 1. Serving as the advisor to the Jazz Ensemble
 - 2. Conduct all rehearsals of the Jazz Ensemble
 - 3. Appointment of the President, Treasurer, and Jazz Ensemble Manager for each school year.
- B. The President's duties shall include:
 - 1. Serving as the AFS representative for the Jazz Ensemble
 - 2. Assisting the Director of Jazz Studies with the running of rehearsals
 - 3. Assisting the Jazz Ensemble Manager with the transportation of equipment
- C. The Treasurer's duties shall include:

1. Working closely with the Director of Jazz Studies to monitor all budgetary issues related to the jazz program
 2. Ensuring that all money earned at concerts is deposited into the proper account
- D. The Jazz Ensemble Manager's duties shall include:
1. Managing the equipment concerns of the ensemble, including setting up the band for rehearsals and concerts, as well as supervising the transportation of equipment to performances outside of the Music Building.
 2. Managing all aspects of the jazz library, including cataloguing new pieces, maintaining an accurate and detailed computer database of the library, and participating in special jazz library projects.
 3. Assisting the Director of Jazz Studies in advertising performances of the jazz ensembles, including making flyers, online advertisements, and press releases. The Jazz Ensemble Manager will also assist in the creation and maintenance of the Furman Jazz Studies website.

Article VI. Amendments

This constitution shall be hereafter subject to amendments. After first obtaining a 3/4 majority vote of the group, the Director may alter any portion of the constitution.